

FireWire: Also called IEEE-1394 or i.Link, this is a serial I/O interface standard that is extremely fast, with data transfer rates up to 400 Mbps, 800 Mbps, or 3.2 Gbps, depending on the version of the standard used. Most current implementations use the 400 Mbps IEEE-1394a and b versions.

ECP (Enhanced Capabilities Port): A type of high-speed parallel port jointly developed by Microsoft and Hewlett-Packard that offers improved performance for the parallel port and requires special hardware logic. ECP ports use both an IRQ and a DMA channel.

USB (Universal Serial Bus): USB version 1.1 is a 12 Mbps (1.5 MBps) interface over a simple four-wire connection. The bus supports up to 127 devices. USB 2.0, also called High-Speed USB, runs at 480 Mbps and handles multiple devices better than does USB 1.1.